THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

Paris Branch: 28 rue des Acacias 75017 PARIS
Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website: http://www.rblfrance.org/ e-mail: paris@rblfrance.org

Patron:
Her Majesty The Queen
Hon. President:
H.B.M. Ambassador

Incorporated by Royal Charter

NEWSLETTER - SEPTEMBER 2011

CONTENTS

Page 1: Chairman's Report
Page 2 - 4: Club Lunches
Page 5: Poppy Coffee Morning
Page 6: Normandy Tour
Page 7 - 8: Subscription letter: *(English and French)*
Page 9: Subscription Renewal Form

Chairman's Report

We trust you have had a pleasant summer break. Borrowing from Keats, here we are again in Autumn, "Season of mists and mellow football boots".

Your Committee meets again on 22nd September, and you will have spotted that the first Club Lunch of the new season takes place on the same day. Inspired by their successful 90th Anniversary Dinner-Dance in May Janet Warby and Joan Hicks have drawn up the attached programme of lunches for the winter season. They are also planning the traditional Poppy Coffee Morning at the Ambassador's Residence. As indicated in their flyer attached this will take place on 3rd November.

We are planning another battlefield visit, this time in Normandy, under the guidance of Branch member Colonel Oliver Warman, late Welsh Guards. The tour takes place on 14th-16th October. You will find the Information Notice attached.

Jointly with the RNVRA we plan to hold a ceremony at the grave of Admiral Sir Bertram Ramsay in Saint Germain-en-Laye Cemetery on Saturday 22nd October. Details will follow. You will recall that Sir Bertram was in charge of the naval operation to bring British and French troops from Dunkirk to England in the Little Ships, and was in 1944 Naval Commander in Chief of the Allied Naval Expeditionary Force in support of the Normandy landings. A pivotal figure in WWII therefore, who died in a plane accident in Toussus-le-Noble on a mission to meet General Montgomery in Brussels in January 1945.

Our Financial Year ends on 30th September, and this is the time of year when next year's subscriptions are paid. Our Membership Secretary Mark Yates has included here his letter to members with the Subscription Renewal Form.

This gives me the opportunity to thank you all on behalf of our Committee for your continuing commitment to the cause of The Royal British Legion. We especially appreciate the moral support given us by members who are not necessarily able to participate in our activities for geographical or health reasons.

Your Committee is planning a range of events in the coming year, and we look forward to seeing you again soon in our Clubhouse.

"We will remember them"

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

CLUB LUNCHES
OCTOBER 2011 – MARCH 2012

OCTOBER

Wednesday 26th **Lunch, 12h15 for 12h30. Three course lunch, Kir & Coffee €15 per person.**
Wine to be bought at the bar either by glass or bottle.

NOVEMBER

Wednesday 16th **Lunch, 12h15 for 12h30. Three course lunch, Kir & Coffee €15 per person.**
Wine to be bought at the bar either by glass or bottle.

DECEMBER

Tuesday 13th **First of Christmas lunches. Price to be advised. Small tombola to be drawn on this day. 12h15 for 12h30.**

Thursday 15th **Second Christmas lunch. Price to be advised.**
Large tombola to be drawn on this day. 12h15 for 12h30.

JANUARY

Wednesday 18th **Lunch, 12h15 for 12h30. Three course lunch, Kir & Coffee €15 per person.**
Wine to be bought at the bar either by glass or bottle.

FEBRUARY

Wednesday 15th **St. Valentines Day lunch. 12h15 for 12h30. Three course lunch, Kir & Coffee €15 per person. Wine to be bought at the bar either by glass or bottle.**

MARCH

Wednesday 14th **Pancake Day lunch. 12h15 for 12h30. Three course lunch, Kir & Coffee €15 per person. Wine to be bought at the bar either by glass or bottle.**

When you decide which lunch you would like to attend, would you please send one cheque per lunch as this makes it easier for us to calculate how many will be attending each lunch. If you have to cancel your reservation for lunch, please inform Joan Hicks no later than 2 working days before the date. Our cook(s) need to buy in supplies and we do not want to waste money or food. Your reservation slips are in with this notice.

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

CLUB LUNCH REPLY SLIPS

I _____
would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on October 26th .

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____
would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on November 16th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____
would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on December 13th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____
would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on December 15th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €
_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____
would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on January 18th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____ would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on February 15th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

I _____ would like to attend the Club Lunch to be held on March 14th

I enclose my cheque made payable to The Royal British Legion, for €
_____

I will be accompanied by
_____

Tel : _____

Please send in your cheque(s) to Miss Joan Hicks, 6 rue des Petits Prés, 78810 Feucherolles, before the date of the lunch(s). This helps with the accounting of these lunches.

We will inform those of you who intend to join one or both of the Christmas lunches of the price as soon as we can. We hope as many of you will attend our Club lunches and bring along your friends. By sending a cheque every time you state you wish to attend a lunch, it will be easier to return your cheque if you are unable to attend.

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION 90th ANNIVERSARY POPPY APPEAL

LADY WESTMACOTT, wife of H.M. Ambassador to France,

has kindly accepted to host a Coffee Morning

in aid of the Poppy Appeal

which the ROYAL BRITISH LEGION, PARIS BRANCH,

organizes every year for the benefit of the

EARL HAIG BENEVOLENT FUND

The Coffee Morning will take place at

THE BRITISH AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE

39 rue du Faubourg St. Honoré,

PARIS 8éme

THURSDAY 3rd NOVEMBER, 2011

10h30 - 12 noon

Please send your <u>stamped address envelope</u> to :
Miss Joan Hicks
6 rue des Petits Prés
78810 Feucherolles

An invitation card for presentation at the entrance will be sent to you. This event is free of charge. Donations welcome.
I.D. Cards or Passports required. Date limit 28/10/2011

BATTLEFIELD VISIT TO NORMANDY

Paris Branches of Oxford University Society and The Royal British Legion

---

As already advertised the next Battlefield Visit will take place in Normandy on Friday 14th - Sunday 16th October 2011. As usual we shall have as our guide Colonel Oliver Warman, late Welsh Guards.

On Friday 14th October we meet for Dinner at our hotel, L'Hotel des Quadrans, 17 rue Gémare, 14000 Caen (Telephone: 02.31.86.25.57). The programme thereafter is as follows:

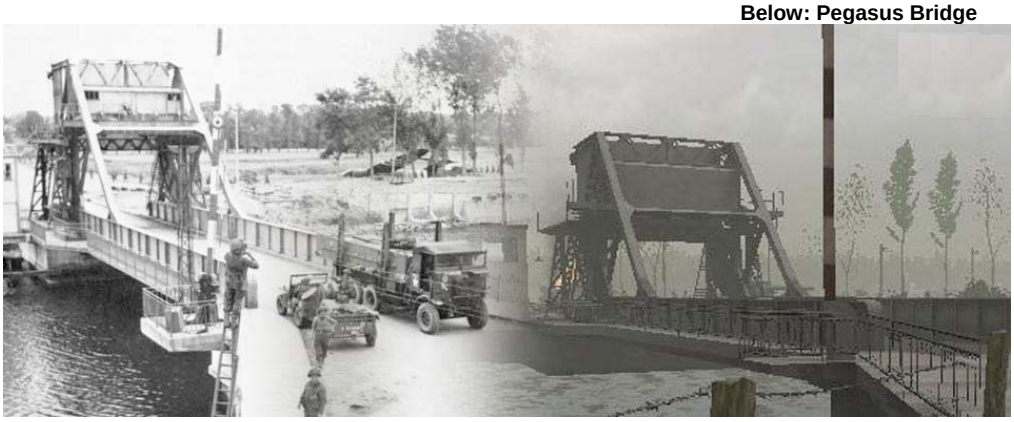
Saturday: Our coach fetches us from the hotel at 9 a.m. (we plan to buy a sandwich lunch on the hoof). Our tour will take us to "Where Rommel stood", Pegasus Bridge, Gold Beach, the Battle of the Sunken Lane which fatefully involved The Green Howards, Jerusalem Cemetery, Omaha Beach (on which Oliver has published a book), the American Cemetery, the Bayeux tapestry, and back to our hotel for dinner.

Sunday: Our coach picks us up again at 9 a.m. (a sandwich lunch on the hoof again).Thence we travel to Villers Bocage, Operation Epsom, Hill 112, Goodwood and the Falaise Gap. At that point anyone who has travelled to Caen by train will be able to take the train back to Paris from Lisieux Station (most likely around 4-5 p.m.). For everyone else the coach will take us back to our hotel in Caen before dispersal.

We have negotiated group rates for our hotel rooms and dinners. For a double room for two people the rate will be 70 euros per night. Singles will in fact occupy a double room for 65 euros a night. The three course Dinner menu including Coffee and House Wine will be 24 euros per head. There will be a cash bar for apéritifs and night caps. We need to add to that the cost of the mini-coach and our contribution to Oliver's expenses (although a professional battlefield guide, he does not charge us a fee) On the assumption that our party is 20 strong the expected cost for a couple will be 390 euros, and 255 euros for the singles. The exact package cost will be confirmed later. We have already booked hotel rooms for 6 singles and 7 doubles. We need to cancel any bookings 20 days before Friday 14th October. Any one cancelling thereafter will only recover 50% of the room price.

Those members wishing to take part in this tour are requested to book their places with me as soon as possible by e-mail: roger.thorn@wanadoo.fr stating any particular dietary requirements. It promises to be another exciting visit under Oliver's tutorship.

Below: Pegasus Bridge



Dear all,

It's me again! Hand out ready to grasp that cheque which, I am sure, you were just on the point of putting in the post to renew your membership of the RBL Paris Branch.

However, for those of you whose memory is fading like mine, let me remind you that subscriptions are due by 1st October.

The good news is that they haven't gone up. I can thus claim, given the galloping inflation that is currently the norm, thanks to our friendly bank managers' manipulation of the economy in recent times, that they have, in a sense, gone down! (at least in relation to the cost of living).

It has been a very full year as you will surely read in the rest of this Newsletter. There have been (and still will be) many events and the Paris Branch has paraded the flag on many occasions in the course of the year.

We should not, however, forget that our primary aim is to help those in need and local requirements for the help which your support provides have increased rather than otherwise. Your subscriptions and gifts go, as always, to relieve hardship, much of it in the English community around us in France

Most of you have e-mail now. If it is a recent acquisition, or if you have changed your address don't forget to let me know at mfyates@gmail.com or paris@rblfrance.org.

Our website, let me remind you, can be consulted at http://www.rblfrance.org. It has quite few uses: you can check upcoming events, put in a free avertisement – and currently link to a petition about expat voting rights.

Subscriptions remain:

- 25 to 64 years old €46
- 65 and over €37
- 25 and under €21

A reply form follows these pages.

Thank you, in advance, all those of you who pay up in October. It makes life so much easier at this end.

Best regards



Mark Yates
Membership secretary

Cher tous,

C'est encore moi! la main tendue et prête à saisir le chèque que vous étiez, bien sûr, sur le point de mettre à la poste pour renouveler votre adhésion à la Royal British Legion, Paris Branch.

Cependant, pour ceux parmi vous dont la mémoire commence à flancher comme la mienne, permettez-moi de vous rappeler que les abonnements se règlent pour le 1er octobre.

La bonne nouvelle, c'est qu'elles n'ont pas augmenté. Ainsi nous pourrions même nous targuer du fait qu'elles sont même (au moins par rapport au coût de la vie, et grâce à l'inflation galopante dont nos banquiers nous ont fait cadeau) en réduction.

L'année 2011 a été très remplie, comme vous allez sûrement pouvoir constater dans les autres chapitres de cette « Newsletter ». Il y a toujours beaucoup d'évènements et le Paris Branch a porté le drapeau à de nombreuses occasions au cours de l'année.

Rappelons-nous, toutefois, que notre but principal est d'aider ceux dans le besoin et c'est pour cela qu'on sollicite votre appui. Les occasions de venir au secours des nécessiteux ici en France sont plutôt en augmentation qu'en diminution. Vos abonnements, vos dons, nous permettent de leur venir en aide d'une façon très pratique.

La plupart d'entre vous disposent d'adresse e-mail maintenant. Si la votre est récente ou si vous l'avez modifiée, faites-moi savoir à mfyates@gmail.com ou paris@rblfrance.org.

Notre site Web, peut se consulter à http://www.rblfrance.org. Le site vous permet de vérifier les détails des événements prochains, de mettre une annonce gratuitement et même, actuellement, d'accéder à une pétition pour le droit de vote pour les expatriés.

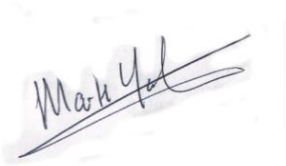
Les abonnements demeurent :

25 à 64 ans	€ 46
65 ans et plus	€ 37
25 ans et moins	€ 21

Un formulaire de réponse se trouve ci-après.

Merci, d'avance à tous ceux qui règleront leur abonnement courant octobre. Cela facilite la tâche...

Bien cordialement
Mark Yates
Membership secretary



THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION PARIS BRANCH

Poppy Appeal & Subscriptions 2011/12
Poppy Appeal et Cotisations 2011/12

- Normal / *Normale* 46 Euros
- Reduced / *Réduite* (65 and + / *65 ans et* +) 37 Euros
- 25 years and under / *25 ans ou moins* 21 Euros

Poppy Appeal contribution
Don au "Poppy Appeal" .....

Annual subscription
Cotisation annuelle .....

Administrative Fund donation
Don aux fonds administratifs .....

TOTAL .....

Name / Nom .....

Address / Adresse .....

.....

Telephone ……

e-mail ……..……..……...

Please tick the box below if you require a fiscal receipt and, if so, enclose a stamped addressed envelope.

Veuillez cocher la case si vous désirer un récépissé fiscal et, dans ce cas, joindre une enveloppe timbrée à votre attention.

☐

Please make your cheque payable to the "Royal British Legion".
Veuillez établir votre cheque à l'ordre de "Royal British Legion"

Royal British Legion. 28 rue des Acacias 75017 PARIS . Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website : **http://www.rblfrance.org/** e-mail : **paris@rblfrance.org**